our host seemed both impressed and surprised by my distance, exactly as my father and brother Wessels had been surprised many years earlier when we were all playing golf, as a family, in Warmbaths.

I was using a three-wood off the tee because my driver was usually just too erratic, and I was quite pleased to walk down the fairways at the par-four 1st, the par-five 4th, the par-four 5th and the par-five 7th ... to find my ball no more than 20 or 30 metres behind Ernie's ball. Jan and I recovered some pride on the back nine, and enjoyed what was an incredible experience, playing golf with a man who knows how to win, and still knows how to have fun.

Lastly, if AB junior turns out to be so inclined, I would very much like my son to enjoy and appreciate music. If he is fortunate enough to inherit his mother's music genes, that will undoubtedly be the case.

When I was growing up, our family home was always filled with music, usually with the golden oldies my parents so enjoyed. I took guitar lessons for two years at Warmbaths Primary School, where I was taught by Jo Fourie, the wife of Louis Fourie, a teacher who later became principal. My interest lapsed for a while at Affies, but a friend of mine, called Johan Booysen, and I enjoyed playing the guitar in our matric year.

Some years later, I took my guitar on tour with the Proteas, thinking it could be useful at social evenings, but the strings snapped and it was awkward to carry around, so I dropped that idea.

It made more sense for me to channel my music energies into writing songs, something I had been doing fairly regularly since leaving school. The process would start with writing a poem; then I would create some kind of melody, try out a few chords on my guitar and develop a tune.

Ampie du Preez is a hugely talented professional musician and we have been friends since we were boys. In 2010 we decided to collaborate and have a real go at producing a proper album. Our commitment was such that we entered into an arrangement with Sony Music and went away for four weeks; we literally cut ourselves off from the world and did not